

WELLNESS

Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) recognizes the connection between adequate nutritious food for student readiness to learn. The Division of School Nutrition Services supports the education mission by participating in various meal programs, because it recognizes the connection between adequate nutritious food and students' readiness to learn. LCPS is committed to providing school environments that promote and protect children's health, well-being, and ability to learn by supporting healthy eating, physical activity, and social emotional wellbeing.

A. Principles.

1. The School Division will strive to engage students, parents, teachers, staff members, food service professionals, health professionals, and other interested community members in developing, implementing, monitoring, and periodically reviewing and updating the Division Wellness Policy.

2. To the maximum extent possible, all schools in the Division shall participate in available federal school meal programs (including the School Breakfast Program, the National School Lunch Program, the Summer Food Service Program and the Child and Adult Care Food Program-Supper). Foods and beverages sold or served through the Division shall meet the nutrient standards established by the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) Smart Snacks for Schools. No funds from Division of School Nutrition Services may be used to support student or non-School Nutrition staff meals of food and beverage charges.

3. Qualified child nutrition professionals shall provide students with access to a variety of affordable, nutritious, and appealing foods that meet the health and nutrition needs of students and will make efforts to accommodate the cultural diversity of the student body in meal planning.

4. All students are encouraged to be physically active in accordance with Policy 5011 (Unstructured Activity Time).

5. LCPS will teach, model, encourage, and support nutrition education and physical education to foster lifelong habits of mindful eating and physical activity for all students. This shall establish linkages among health and physical education, school meal programs, and related community services. Grade-level appropriate, medically aware, and culturally-responsive education materials will be provided.

6. Schools will support the development of emotional and social wellness in students to help improve overall resiliency and self-esteem.

B. Nutrition Integrity of Foods and Beverages Sold and Served on Campus.

1. School Meals. The Division of School Nutrition Services shall share information about the nutritional content and the ingredients of meals with parents and students via the School Nutrition website, cafeteria menu boards, and point-of-purchase signage.

2. Free and Reduced- Priced Meals. Schools shall prevent the overt identification of these students.

WELLNESS

3. Breakfast. Parents and students will be notified of the availability of the School Breakfast Program.

4. Summer Food Service Program. Summer Food Service Program sites will be determined annually by the Division. Sites that qualify more than 50 percent of their students as eligible for free or reduced-price school meals will participate in the Summer Food Service Program.

5. Meal Times and Scheduling. Schools should use the following guidelines for serving school meals:

- a. Provide students with at least 10 minutes to eat after receiving breakfast and 15 minutes after sitting down for lunch on an average day.
- b. Campuses should serve lunch between 10:00 a.m. and 2:00 p.m. An exemption may be applied through VDOE for unusual circumstances for their review and approval.

6. Snacks. Snacks sold or served during the school day, or in after-school programs shall make a positive contribution to children's diet and health.

7. Student Hydration. Schools should promote drinking water availability as an essential component of student wellness by improving access to free, safe drinking water in varied locations on school campuses and encouraging drinking water throughout the day.

8. Food and Beverages Sold.

- a. School Nutrition Services is the primary provider of nutritious food and beverages during the school day. Per 7 CFR 210.10, 7 CFR 210.11, and 7 CFR 220.8, no food or beverages other than those sold by School Nutrition Services shall be sold to students from 6:00 a.m. until after the final breakfast bell, nor during any lunch periods.
- b. All food and beverages sold in the school during the school day to students (defined as from 12:00 a.m. until 30 minutes after the final bell, with exception as noted in section 7) shall meet the nutrition standards outlined by USDA, referred to as Smart Snacks.

9. Fundraisers Involving the Sale of Food and/or Beverages.

- a. Exempt fundraisers are tracked and monitored by the school wellness representative (or school financial technician) and records are kept in the school wellness policy Google Drive.
- b. Any fundraiser that sells food or beverages may not be conducted during school meal service times. This includes from 6:00 a.m. to

WELLNESS

the end of the breakfast period and from the beginning of the first lunch period to the end of the last lunch period.

- c. Each public school shall be permitted to conduct, on the school campus during regular school hours, no more than 30 school-sponsored fundraisers per school year during which food or beverages may be sold to students that do not meet the nutrition standards in 8VAC20-740- 35 or in the U.S. Department of Agriculture's regulations.

10. Food Modeling, Behavior, and Advertising.

- a. Schools shall discourage students from sharing their foods or beverages with one another during meal or snack times. Given concerns about allergies and other restrictions in certain children's diets, food, and beverages should not be shared. Refer to LCPS Procedural Handbook for Supporting Students with Allergies for additional relevant information.
- b. School employees shall not use food or beverages to reward students for good behavior and achievement in the classroom. School staff shall not withhold food, including food served through school meals, as a punishment.

C. Nutrition Education. The School Division shall follow the current Health Education Standards of Learning for Virginia Public Schools. The School Division will provide classroom nutrition education each year for all students in kindergarten through grade ten. School Nutrition Services' registered dietitians may serve as a resource for current, evidence-based nutrition information.

D. Physical Education. LCPS shall provide a Physical Education Program for all students in kindergarten through grade12 that shall include students with disabilities and with special health-care needs, as well as students in alternative educational settings.

1. Physical Education Instruction Kindergarten through Grade 10. Physical education classes shall provide students with instruction that is aligned with the Virginia Standards of Learning and the LCPS Physical Education Curriculum in order to prepare all students with the knowledge and skills to develop healthy lifestyles.

E. Physical Activity Opportunities.

1. Daily, unstructured activity time during the school day is encouraged per Policy 5011. The recess period shall meet the following criteria: Space and equipment are provided to students to engage in moderate vigorous physical activity with encouragement of teachers.

2. After-school childcare and enrichment programs shall work cooperatively with the School Division to provide and encourage – through the provision of space, equipment, activities and teacher support – daily periods of moderate- to- vigorous physical activity for all participants.

WELLNESS

F. Social and Emotional Wellness. A comprehensive approach to the social and emotional health of students as defined by the Virginia Department of Education Standard for Counseling Programs supports student learning and creates a safe, inclusive school culture and climate. LCPS supports the implementation of a comprehensive social and emotional wellness approach in which students learn to establish positive relationships, recognize, and manage emotions, identify risk of harm to self or others, support factors and develop healthy coping strategies. LCPS' social and emotional wellness program goals and strategies to assess social and emotional wellness are further set forth and operationalized in the accompanying Regulation 6120.

1. School Wide School Division Strategies to Assess Social and Emotional Wellness.

- a. Schools will conduct team-based assessments and evaluations on students who are in crisis.
- b. School personnel will follow suicide screening protocols as directed by Loudoun County Public Schools School Board policy.
- c. School personnel will follow threat assessment protocols as directed by Loudoun County Public Schools School Board policy.
- d. As needed, school personnel will refer students and families to community based mental health professionals or emergency rooms.
- e. Schools will assess the needs of the students every year.
- f. Schools will provide professional development for teachers to include social/emotional wellness.
- g. Schools will develop school-wide prevention/education programs.
- h. Schools will conduct annual data collection on school climate.

G. Other Opportunities for Promoting Student Wellness. The Wellness Policy will be followed during grant-directed activities, school celebrations, and extracurricular activities. Parents will be informed when appropriate or feasible.

H. Department and School Staff Wellness. The School Division values the health and well-being of every staff member and shall plan and implement activities and policies that support personal efforts by staff members to maintain a healthy lifestyle. A healthy lifestyle includes good nutrition, physical fitness, and mental and emotional wellness. It also includes reducing or eliminating stress, the use of tobacco products, and alcohol consumption. The School Division will take the following actions to improve staff wellness:

WELLNESS

1. Develop a voluntary program to offer incentives to staff members who make healthy lifestyle choices. Programs shall be developed, implemented, and monitored with the support of the Supervisor of Employee Benefits in the Department of Human Resources and Talent Development (HRTD).

2. Permit parents, students, representatives of school nutrition, physical education teachers, school health professionals, the school board, school administrators and the general public to participate in the development, implementation and periodic review and update of the Wellness Policy.

3. Encourage nutritious eating, physical activity, elimination of the use of tobacco products, and other elements of a healthy lifestyle.

4. Offer professional learning opportunities, workshops, and/or information that encourage physical, mental, nutritional, and relational health.

I. Modeling Wellness. The School Division shall continue providing strategies for teachers, parents, school administrators, students, school nutrition professionals, and community members to serve as models in practicing nutritious eating, physical activities, and mental and emotional hygiene, reducing or eliminating stress, eliminating use of tobacco products and alcohol consumption, and not using illegal drugs both in school and at home. School staff are encouraged to consider modeling healthy behaviors such as drinking water and consuming nutritious meals and snacks. School staff should practice sensitivity to remarks regarding self-esteem and media images and refrain from making remarks regarding body image,

J. Assessments. The relevant staff and departments within the School Division will evaluate, and if necessary, implement improvements to enhance the safety and ease of students walking or biking to school, as well as entering the school building when transportation is provided by parents, guardians, or caregivers. When appropriate, the Division shall work with local public works, public safety, and/or police departments in those efforts. The School Division shall explore the availability of federal "Safe Routes to School" funds, administered by the Virginia Department of Transportation, to finance such improvements.

K. Compliance. School Nutrition Services staff, at the school or Division level, shall ensure compliance with USDA regulations within school nutrition service areas and shall report to the Chief-Financial Officer. The Division will retain records to document compliance with the requirements of the Wellness Policy.

1. A summary report shall be developed every three years on compliance with the Division's established Wellness Policy.

L. Implementation of the Wellness Policy. The Chief Financial Officer shall conduct an assessment of the school's existing nutrition, physical activity and social emotional environments and policies. The results of those assessments shall be compiled by the Division to identify and prioritize needs.

1. Assessments shall be repeated triennially to help review policy compliance, assess progress, and determine opportunities for improvement. The Division, and each school and department within the Division, shall, as necessary, provide information to revise the Wellness Policy and develop action plans to facilitate

WELLNESS

implementation of the Wellness Policy. The policy, most recent assessments, updates, and implementation status will be made available to the public annually.

2. The Chief Financial Officer is responsible for implementing and monitoring this policy.

[Former Policy 3-4]

Adopted: 4/4/06

Revised: 10/22/19

Current Revision: 1/14/25

Legal Refs: Food and Nutrition Services, Department of Agriculture, 7 Code Federal Regulations Chapter II §§ 210.1-210.33, 220.1-22, National School Lunch Act, 42 U.S.C. § 1751 et seq; 7 CFR 210.31(c)(3), 7 CFR 210.31(c)(3)(iii), 7 CFR 210.31(d)(3), 7 CFR 210.31(f), 7 CFR 210.10(a)(1)(i), 7 CFR 210.10(l)(1), 7 CFR 210.11(b)(4); Code of Virginia §§ 22.1-79.7, 22.1-16.4, 22.1-207; 8VAC20-740-35

Cross Refs: Policy 7550, Drug- And Alcohol-Free Workplace; Policy 7552, Smoke-Free Workplace; Policy 5011, Unstructured Activity Time